

Batch Scripting Beginner's Guide

Welcome to the Batch Scripting Beginner's Guide!

1. What is a Batch Script?

A batch file is a script file in DOS, OS/2 and Microsoft Windows. It consists of a series of commands to be executed by the command-line interpreter, stored in a plain text file.

2. Basic Commands

- echo: Prints out text. (e.g. echo Hello World)
- @echo off: Hides the command from printing before execution.
- pause: Halts execution and waits for the user to press a key.
- rem or :: : Used for adding comments to your script.

3. Variables

To set a variable, use:

```
set myVar=Hello
```

To use a variable, wrap it in percent signs:

```
echo %myVar%
```

4. Conditionals (IF statements)

```
if "%myVar%"=="Hello" (  
    echo The variable is Hello!  
) else (  
    echo The variable is something else!  
)
```

5. Loops (FOR loop)

```
for %%a in (1 2 3 4 5) do (  
    echo %%a
```

)

6. Resources to Learn More

- SS64 (ss64.com/nt/)
- Microsoft Docs (learn.microsoft.com/en-us/windows-server/administration/windows-commands/)
- Tutorialspoint Batch Script Tutorial

BatchForge allows you to test these scripts safely using its built-in Execution Engine.